

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

SENATE

RESOLUTION 42

By: Hicks

AS INTRODUCED

A Resolution recognizing April as Sexual Assault Awareness Month and April 29, 2026, as Denim Day; supporting Peace Over Violence and the YWCA; and directing distribution.

WHEREAS, April is nationally recognized as Sexual Assault Awareness Month and the Peace Over Violence organization has declared April 29, 2026, as Denim Day; and

WHEREAS, the origin of Denim Day began in 1992 after the Italian Supreme Court's overturning of a sexual assault conviction. The next day, women members of the Italian Parliament gathered on the steps of the Supreme Court wearing denim to protest the fact that the justices had agreed with the defense attorney's argument that the young woman's jeans were proof of consent; and

WHEREAS, in 1999, the organization Peace Over Violence held its first Denim Day to protest myths about why women and girls are victims of sexual assault; and

WHEREAS, sexual harassment is part of a continuum of violence whose damaging effects are felt throughout our culture. Harmful

1 attitudes about all forms of sexual violence allow these issues to
2 persist and allow victims and survivors to be revictimized; and

3 WHEREAS, every sixty seconds someone in the U.S. is sexually
4 assaulted, and the vast majority of victims are female. In
5 Oklahoma, the rate of rape and attempted rape among females reported
6 to law enforcement has been 35 to 45 percent higher than the U.S.
7 rate for the past decade. The actual numbers are believed to be
8 higher due to the fact that many survivors do not report sexual
9 assault crimes due to fear and shame; and

10 WHEREAS, sexual violence and its unfair and traumatizing effects
11 are preventable with proper education and comprehensive prevention
12 projects; and

13 WHEREAS, members of the Oklahoma State Senate strongly support
14 the efforts of Peace Over Violence and the YWCA to educate persons
15 in our state about the true impact of sexual harassment, abuse,
16 assault, and rape.

17 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
18 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

19 THAT the Oklahoma State Senate recognizes the month of April as
20 Sexual Assault Awareness Month.

21 THAT the Oklahoma State Senate designates April 29, 2026, as
22 Denim Day and urges everyone to wear jeans on this day to help
23 communicate the message that there is no excuse and there is never
24 an invitation to harass, abuse, assault, or rape.

1 THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to the YWCA.

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